

Project UNNATI – Rural Skill and Placement Initiatives

Detailed Information Summary

Scope clarification

This document covers Project UNNATI for skilling Mahatma Gandhi NREGA workers under the Ministry of Rural Development. It is different from UNNATI-2024, the industrial incentive scheme for the North-Eastern Region.

1. About Project UNNATI

Project UNNATI is a skilling initiative launched in December 2019 to upgrade the skill base of Mahatma Gandhi NREGA workers. Its purpose is to help eligible rural households move from partial employment to fuller and more sustainable employment, reducing dependence on MGNREGA.

2. Main objectives

- Improve the employability and livelihood prospects of MGNREGA households.
- Provide access to wage-employment-linked skill training.
- Provide self-employment and entrepreneurship training.
- Connect rural workers with DDU-GKY, RSETIs and Krishi Vigyan Kendras.
- Promote sustainable income and economic self-reliance.

3. Target and coverage

The project was designed to train 2,00,000 beneficiaries across 26 States and 2 Union Territories. The official MGNREGA portal describes eligibility for one adult member of a household that completed 100 days of MGNREGA work in the relevant previous financial years. The exact commencement-year and current eligibility rules must be checked against the latest revised guidelines.

4. Eligible household member

The project generally covers one adult member from an eligible MGNREGA household. For DDU-GKY, the normal rural-youth age group is 15–35 years, with special groups eligible up to 45 years under DDU-GKY rules. For RSETI/KVK routes, the Project UNNATI description refers to adults aged 18–45 years. The household's 100-day MGNREGA work condition and any current State verification requirements apply.

5. Two training pathways

A. Wage employment pathway: DDU-GKY – Deen Dayal Upadhyaya Grameen Kaushalya Yojana. Eligible candidates may select approved placement-linked training programmes run by Project Implementing Agencies (PIAs).

B. Self-employment pathway: RSETI and KVK – Rural Self Employment Training Institutes and Krishi Vigyan Kendras. Candidates may choose approved entrepreneurship, agriculture or allied-activity training programmes.

6. DDU-GKY details

DDU-GKY is a demand-driven, placement-linked skill-development programme for rural poor youth. Training is generally free for eligible candidates and may include lodging, boarding, transport and other approved costs. DDU-GKY guidelines require placement outcomes for trained candidates, with the programme commonly specifying a 70% placement requirement for applicable projects. Training duration, job role, salary, placement support and post-placement support depend on the approved project and current DDU-GKY guidelines.

7. RSETI details

RSETIs are bank-led, Ministry of Rural Development-supported institutions that provide skill and entrepreneurship development training. They support unemployed rural youth and other eligible participants interested in self-employment or wage employment. Courses may cover agriculture, services, manufacturing, trade and other locally viable activities. Course eligibility and duration vary by institute.

8. KVK details

Krishi Vigyan Kendras are agricultural training and extension institutions under the agricultural system. Under UNNATI, eligible beneficiaries may choose suitable training offered by KVKs, especially in agriculture and allied activities. Possible areas include crop production, horticulture, animal husbandry, fisheries, food processing, farm-based enterprises and related livelihood activities, subject to local course availability.

9. Implementation and convergence

Project UNNATI is implemented through convergence between the Rural Skills Division of the Ministry of Rural Development, the MGNREGA Division, KVKs under the Ministry of Agriculture and the training ecosystem of DDU-GKY and RSETIs. Local MGNREGA functionaries help identify eligible households and facilitate participation.

10. Selection and participation process

1. Identify a household that meets the applicable MGNREGA work condition.
2. Select one eligible adult member.
3. Obtain information from the Gram Panchayat, MGNREGA office, Block Programme Officer, State Rural Livelihoods Mission, RSETI, KVK or DDU-GKY training centre.
4. Choose wage employment or self-employment training.
5. Complete registration, counselling and document verification.
6. Attend the approved training programme.
7. For DDU-GKY, participate in placement and post-placement support; for RSETI/KVK, pursue the business or livelihood plan.

11. Documents commonly requested

MGNREGA job card/household details, Aadhaar or other identity proof, mobile number, residence details, bank account information, age proof, photographs, caste/category certificate where applicable, education details and any documents requested by the training institution. The final checklist is State- and programme-specific.

12. Benefits and support

Depending on the selected pathway and current rules, support may include free training, residential facilities, meals, travel assistance, training materials, certification, placement assistance, post-placement support, entrepreneurship counselling and technical guidance. Benefits are not identical across DDU-GKY, RSETI and KVK.

13. Important limitations

Project UNNATI is not a universal cash-transfer scheme. It is primarily a skilling and livelihood-support project. Training availability depends on approved centres, courses, State plans and eligibility verification. Completion of training does not automatically guarantee a job or loan.

14. Official status information

The official MGNREGA portal describes a target of 2 lakh beneficiaries. A PIB update reported that 90,894 candidates had been trained by 31 March 2025. Earlier portal figures may differ because reporting dates and revisions differ. Use the latest official dashboard or Ministry release for current achievement data.

15. Official documents and websites

Revised Project UNNATI Guidelines PDF:

https://nregaplus.nic.in/netnrega/writereaddata/Circulars/2470Revised_Guidelines_on_Project_Unnati_2023.pdf

MGNREGA official portal – UNNATI: https://nrega.dord.gov.in/MGNREGA_new/ic.aspx

MGNREGA home: https://nrega.dord.gov.in/MGNREGA_new/Nrega_home.aspx/stHome.aspx

DDU-GKY official portal: <https://kaushalbharat.gov.in/>

Ministry of Rural Development: <https://rural.gov.in/>

16. Disclaimer

This is a prepared detailed summary for educational and government-scheme website-project use. It is not an official Government notification, application form or legal advice. Age limits, household conditions, training availability, benefits, placement rules and reporting figures may change. Verify the latest revised guidelines and local instructions before publishing or applying.